getting his post-graduation degree, Samanta was convinced his destiny was to help children from poor tribal families in remote areas to get an education.

KIIT started as a small endeavour in a rented two-room house with a capital of just Rs 5,000—it now has 30,000 students in its residential institute in Bhubaneswar, 20,000 alumni and 10,000 students in 10 satellite centres all over Odisha. KISS alumni, similarly, have gone on to contribute to society, bringing change within the community. While KIIT charged an annual capitation fee of Rs 100,000 and Rs 200,000 from under-graduate and post-graduate students, respectively, who could afford to do so, KISS imparted education, including vocational training, free of cost to students from kindergarten to post-graduation. The Kalinga network employs 15,000 people directly and around 200,000 indirectly.

Samanta's contribution is not just limited to the formal education sector, he has also done great work in the fields of rural development, social service, healthcare, women empowerment while helping identify and groom budding talent in the art, culture and sports arenas. He has already transformed Kalarabanka into a smart village with modern amenities like WiFi, hospitals and English-medium schools. His endeavour is to set up 40 branches of KISS in Odisha and beyond. Three branches have already been opened—one in Delhi and two in Bangladesh.

And even though, as a parliamentarian, Samanta is required to be in the capital often, he continues to live a simple life in his humble two-bedroom flat in Bhubaneswar. Nothing can come in the way of his journey to provide education and inspire real change. ■

HAPPINESS MANTRA

"For me, happiness is when the head, heart and hand are in harmony. If you are happy, you can spread happiness to others. Happiness is contagious"

Dr ACHYUTA SAMANTA

Happiness Quest: *A joint enterprise of India Today and the RPG Group that celebrates exemplary initiatives to spread happiness*

Happiness IS HOMEMADE

Principal architect with Design Consortium India, **NILANJAN BHOWAL** *tells us how to create spaces that exude a sense of calm*

Architecture and interior design go well beyond optimising space requirements, light and ventilation and require a more holistic approach, keeping in mind the mental wellbeing and happiness of its inhabitants. Here are key design tips that can convert any home into a tranquil space:

1. Put in a lot of greenery and use therapeutic plants such as the palm, snake plant, spider plant and aloe vera. If there is a green patch for plantations, grow your own micro greens. Looking after plants, watching them grow and nurturing them heals the mind psychologically.
2. Ensure that every room gets sufficient natural light and ventilation by creating larger windows and openings. Use light-coloured fabrics and light colours on walls so that they reflect a lot of light. Bright, cheerful spaces create a happy home.
3. Colours affect the composition and experience of the room. Going back to the basics of colour theory, each shade on the spectrum brings out a specific emotion. Keep walls in neutral shades as they remain permanent, but rotate artefacts, accessories, throws and rugs.
4. Too much clutter may take away from the harmony of the space; cluttered spaces result in a cluttered mind. Minimalism is a philosophy known to create wellness.
5. Create a corner in the house as your wellness corner, where you can be with your own self and meditate, read a book or just sit and listen to music. You can even convert balconies and smaller alcoves into nice nooks for your wellness space by placing some partitions and furniture.

-By Shelly Anand

